CLIENT-FACING ASSESSMENT / 14 MARCH 2029

IRONVALE FREIGHT

Lease comparison compliance assessment

Decision-pack release readiness for the 22 March 2029 office decision

PREPARED FOR	Oona Hollingsworth	**PREPARED BY**	Antoni Underwood
TEAM	Marchbank Components shared-property team	**ROLE**	Enterprise real estate broker

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This assessment reviews whether the client-facing comparison is supported by dated evidence, uses a like-for-like economic scope and communicates uncertainty clearly. It assesses evidence, comparison readiness and client communication. It does not choose an option; Ironvale Freight retains the decision.

DEFINED TERM: OCCUPANCY COST

In this assessment, **recurring occupancy cost** means the charges required to keep and occupy a premises over the lease period: fixed or base rent; applicable operating-expense recoveries or pass-throughs, such as common-area charges, property taxes or insurance; and separately paid utilities and occupancy services. Concessions and landlord contributions are shown as offsets only in the periods and under the conditions where they are verified to apply.

All-in decision cost keeps that recurring subtotal visible and adds one-time costs needed to take and occupy the premises, including tenant-funded fit-out, transaction or transition costs, move effects, overlap and existing-premises exit or continuing-liability effects. The two layers must remain visibly separate. No cost figure is supplied or asserted in this assessment.

CURRENT FINDING

NOT DECISION-READY FOR A LOWEST-COST DESCRIPTION

The material available for this handoff does not substantiate consolidation as the lowest-cost option. The normalized occupancy-cost comparison is not yet decision-ready. The earlier consolidation statement is prior communication requiring correction, not a verified fact, comparison input or presentation label.

DECISION FRAME

22 March 2029	Renew both existing offices; or consolidate into one headquarters.
Decision authority	Ironvale Freight decides. The broker provides a neutral evidence and communication assessment.
Case boundary	Renewal retains the combined economics of both existing offices. Consolidation includes the new headquarters and the economic consequences of exiting or carrying the existing offices.

CONTROL DATES

Date	What it controls	Status in this handoff
28 February 2029	Frozen market-evidence cutoff and required baseline	Snapshot not supplied or reviewed; no market fact is asserted
14 March 2029, 5:00 p.m.	Assessment due to Oona, leaving time to correct the pack	Current assessment date
22 March 2029	Ironvale Freight decision date	Later than the evidence cutoff
Through 31 March 2029	Legacy headline-rent-per-square-foot view may still appear	Context and continuity only
From 1 April 2029	Normalized occupancy-cost view is required	Controlling economic view after cutover

01 / EVIDENCE STATUS

What can be said now

The handoff identifies a material source conflict and a circulating conclusion, but supplies none of the underlying snapshot, correspondence, lease abstracts or financial model. Status labels below prevent a reader from mistaking a statement for a commitment.

EVIDENCE LABELS USED THROUGHOUT

Label	Plain-language meaning	How it may be used
Verified fact	Supported by a reviewed source whose source and effective or as-of date are recorded.	May support a comparison input, subject to scope checks.
Third-party statement / quote	A term, availability statement or quotation reported by another party; it is not automatically a commitment.	Use only with source, date and commercial-status disclosure.
Estimate	A calculated or market-based approximation with a stated method, date and, where material, a range.	Use for planning or sensitivity, not as a settled term.
Assumption	An explicit placeholder selected because an input is missing or uncertain.	Keep visible and test its effect; never disguise it as fact.
Unresolved item	Missing, conflicting or unconfirmed information.	Keep pending and link it to the claim or calculation it blocks; do not treat it as zero.

CURRENT SOURCE AND CLAIM STATUS

Material	Status for this assessment	Decision consequence
Frozen 28 February market snapshot	Required market baseline, but not supplied or reviewed here.	No rent, area, term or availability from the snapshot can be stated as verified.
Client-email descriptions of terms and availability	The handoff identifies a conflict with the frozen snapshot. The disputed details and correspondence are not supplied.	Neither version controls until each is dated, sourced and reconciled.
Two existing-office lease abstracts and headquarters proposal	Not supplied.	The renewal and consolidation cases cannot yet be shown with complete term, area, allocation or exit scope.
Financial model	Not supplied.	Whole-period, annualized, per-area and timing-adjusted results cannot be validated.
Earlier consolidation-is-lowest-cost statement	Prior communication only; not evidence or a model input.	Withdraw or qualify the label pending a normalized comparison. Repetition does not substantiate it.

GAP TO CONSEQUENCE

Unresolved gap	What the reader cannot validate
Lease and proposal economics	Whether recurring charges, recoveries, escalations, concessions, fit-out obligations and existing-premises liabilities are complete for both cases.
Market and availability conflict	Whether a described term or site condition was available or effective at the relevant date; later information cannot silently replace the baseline.
Common financial basis	Whether totals use the same horizon, base date, currency, tax treatment, nominal/real basis and treatment of cash timing.
Operational inputs	Whether each case has sufficient capacity and functional fit, and whether possession, overlap, move timing or disruption changes the practical result.

Evidence rule: every material input must carry an identifiable source and effective or as-of date. Information received after the frozen cutoff is separately dated, labeled and reconciled in a change record.

02 / LIKE-FOR-LIKE STANDARD

What the comparison must include

A defensible comparison uses the same component scope, time basis and units for both cases. Lease labels and headline rates describe allocation; they do not, by themselves, establish economic comparability.

RECURRING OCCUPANCY COST

Show fixed or base rent; applicable recoveries or pass-throughs; separately paid utilities and occupancy services; contractual escalations or review mechanisms; and concessions or landlord contributions in the periods and under the conditions where they apply.

Full-service, gross, modified-gross and net are labels describing how costs are allocated. For each proposal, identify included and excluded components rather than comparing the labels or opening rents alone.

ONE-TIME AND TRANSITION COST

Show tenant-funded fit-out and transaction or transition costs needed to occupy the premises, including move, furniture, equipment, technology, overlap and existing-premises exit or continuing-liability effects.

For tenant improvements, distinguish gross project cost, landlord allowance and the tenant's net funded amount. An allowance is not the same measure as project cost.

NORMALIZATION CONTROLS

Control	Required treatment	If missing or different
Area basis	Identify rentable, usable or another stated convention for each premises. Use the same convention for both cases.	Do not assume a load factor or convert between rentable and usable area without a known source and conversion basis.
Case scope	Renewal includes both existing offices and their combined economic effect. Consolidation includes the headquarters plus exit, overlap, sublease or continuing-liability effects for existing offices, where applicable.	An omitted premises or liability makes the case incomplete, not cheaper.
Term and timing	Use a common evaluation horizon, or disclose and reconcile unlike terms. Record commencement, possession and any simultaneous-occupancy period. Assign free rent to the periods where it applies.	Do not turn a time-bound concession into a permanent rent reduction.
Price and escalation	Use a common valuation or pricing base date and include contractual rent steps, indexation or review mechanisms over the horizon.	Post-cutoff changes need their own date and reconciliation; opening rent alone is insufficient.
Financial basis	State currency, tax treatment and nominal-versus-real basis. Where cash timing materially differs, use a stated present-value convention; otherwise label undiscounted totals and their limitation.	Unlabeled bases cannot be compared as if they were equivalent.
Uncertainty and outputs	Use ranges, scenarios or sensitivity for uncertain recoveries, fit-out, timing or exit costs. Show whole-period cost and a clearly labeled annual or annualized view from the same components.	Do not create point precision from an unresolved input.
Per-area view	Only show a per-area measure when both the area convention and the cost numerator are the same for both cases.	A square-foot number with a different denominator or component scope is not like-for-like.

Minimum output convention

Present two visibly labeled layers for each case: (1) recurring occupancy-cost subtotal and (2) all-in decision cost, which adds the one-time implementation and exit effects. Both must use the same horizon, base date and component definitions. A missing amount remains **unresolved**; it is not silently omitted or entered as zero.

03 / NEUTRAL DECISION CONDITIONS

What would have to be true

These are testable conditions, not a scorecard and not a recommendation. None is confirmed on the material supplied for this initial assessment.

Renewal of both existing offices

Could be economically or operationally preferable only if the following conditions are evidenced:

- The combined recurring and all-in decision cost of **both** existing offices is verified over a common horizon and base date, with recoveries, utilities/services, escalations, concessions, fit-out and material ancillary costs included where applicable.
- Any renewal work, transaction cost, local move, overlap or restoration obligation is identified; no missing value is treated as zero or left outside the option total.
- Both locations have verified capacity and functional fit for Ironvale's needs, with acceptable access, continuity and timing; operational disruption is assessed separately from cost.
- Sources, effective dates, assumptions and sensitivities are visible, and the less favorable office has not been omitted from the case.

Consolidation into one headquarters

Could be economically or operationally preferable only if the following conditions are evidenced:

- Verified recurring and all-in economics for the one-headquarters case show any claimed benefit only after fit-out, move, technology, overlap, transaction and existing-office exit or continuing-liability costs are included on the same basis.
- Headquarters availability, area convention, term, recoveries, escalations, concessions and landlord allowance are confirmed or clearly labeled; asking, indicative and expected negotiated terms are not treated as commitments.
- Commencement, possession and the move plan are feasible, and termination, surrender, make-good/restoration, sublease or continuing obligations for both existing offices are resolved or transparently carried in the model.
- The headquarters has verified capacity and functional fit, with an acceptable transition and level of operational disruption; unresolved variables are shown through ranges or scenarios.

SHARED DECISION LENS

Use normalized recurring and all-in components, not headline rent alone. Any conclusion must survive material uncertainty in recoveries, fit-out, timing and exit costs.	Keep capacity, functional fit, possession timing and operational disruption visible as separate considerations. Do not monetize unsupported effects.	Ironvale Freight makes the option decision. The designated pack approver controls changes to inputs and labels before release; the broker reports readiness and limitations.

NEUTRAL RELEASE LANGUAGE

No alternative is selected by this assessment

The pack may describe the conditions that would support either case. It should not preserve a previous consolidation conclusion merely for consistency with earlier communication, and it should not replace that conclusion with a renewal conclusion without evidence.

04 / PRESENTATION CHANGEOVER

One pack that remains clear after the cutover

Ironvale may continue using the pack after the end-state standard takes effect. The artifact therefore needs a visible bridge between the permitted legacy view and the controlling normalized view.

TRANSITION RULE

View	Permitted role	Required treatment
Legacy headline rent per square foot	May appear through 31 March 2029 for continuity or context.	Label visibly: **Legacy continuity metric - incomplete economic view; not a decision measure.** Do not use it to rank the alternatives.
Normalized occupancy-cost view	Required from 1 April 2029 and the controlling economic view after cutover.	Show recurring subtotal and all-in decision cost with component schedule, dates, status labels and unresolved items. It is the controlling view, not a co-equal second answer.

TRACEABLE BRIDGE

1	**Legacy context**	Retain the historical headline rate only with its source, as-of date, lease-structure label and area convention.
2	**Recurring schedule**	Map base rent, applicable recoveries/pass-throughs, utilities/services, escalations and time-bound concessions into the recurring subtotal for each case.
3	**Implementation schedule**	Show gross fit-out cost, landlord allowance and tenant net funded amount, then move/furniture/equipment/technology, transaction, overlap and exit/carrying effects.
4	**Decision view**	Use the same component numerator and area denominator for whole-period, annualized and any per-area output. Explain every difference between the legacy and normalized views.

Why headline rent can mislead

A headline rent per square foot may bundle different charges under full-service, gross, modified-gross or net structures. Recoveries can sit outside the headline; free rent and landlord contributions can be time-bound; fit-out and move costs can be absent; and rentable and usable areas can use different denominators. The metric is therefore useful for continuity only when its limits are visible, not as proof that one alternative costs less.

Version control rule

Keep the frozen 28 February 2029 snapshot as the baseline. Any information received after that cutoff is separately dated, labeled and reconciled; it does not silently overwrite the baseline. Reconcile the client-email conflict before release. After 1 April 2029, the normalized view controls even if the legacy view remains visible as historical context.

05 / ACTION AND RELEASE GATE

Correct the pack before the decision

The sequence below protects the 22 March 2029 decision without selecting an alternative. Target dates are working completion points for the correction effort; they are not market or lease facts.

PRIORITIZED CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

Priority	Responsible role	Expected output	Target completion
P1	Designated pack owner with Antoni	Withdraw or qualify the circulating lowest-cost label; issue neutral client wording that classifies it as prior communication pending normalized evidence.	Before any corrected pack is circulated; 14 March handoff
P1	Lease evidence owner / broker	Dated source ledger and abstracts for both existing offices plus the headquarters proposal or availability record: term, area, included/excluded charges, escalations, concessions and exit provisions.	15-17 March
P1	Finance or model owner	Common-basis comparison schedule with recurring subtotal and all-in decision cost, whole-period and annualized views, area convention, currency/tax/nominal-real basis, timing treatment and ranges for uncertain inputs.	18-19 March
P2	Operations / facilities owner	Capacity and functional-fit check, possession and move timing, overlap, disruption, and material parking, storage or signage requirements for both cases.	19 March
P2	Antoni / comparison reviewer	Reconciled snapshot-versus-email change log, evidence labels, gap-to-consequence register and legacy-to-normalized bridge reviewed in parallel for both cases.	20 March
P3	Designated pack approver	After P1/P2 evidence review, approve changed inputs and labels; apply final presentation only when unresolved items are visible and no unsupported option label remains.	21 March, before decision

RELEASE GATE FOR OONA

As at 14 March 2029, release this document as a readiness assessment only. A choice-supporting comparison can be issued before 22 March only when each material input has a source and effective/as-of date; both cases use the same component scope, horizon, base date and financial basis; the snapshot conflict is reconciled; the prior lowest-cost statement is withdrawn or clearly qualified; and the designated approver records every remaining unresolved item. If those conditions are not met, say so plainly and do not state that either alternative is lowest cost.

CLIENT DISCLOSURES AND LIMITATIONS

Reader needs to know	Disclosure
No source pack reviewed	The frozen market snapshot, client emails, lease abstracts and financial model were not supplied for this initial assessment. No market, lease, area, availability or cost figure is verified here.
Commercial status	Asking terms, indicative quotations and expected negotiated terms are different statuses and require verification. Availability is time-sensitive and must be revalidated close to the decision. Final obligations arise from reviewed and executed documents, not from this assessment.
Scope and authority	This is an evidence and communication-readiness assessment under the stated presentation changeover. It is not a jurisdiction-specific legal, tax or accounting opinion, does not create an offer or commitment, and does not select an office strategy.
Missing information	Unknown monetary, area and timing inputs remain unresolved; they are not zero and are not silently omitted. Assumptions and estimates must be labeled and tested with ranges or scenarios.

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